



**Seeing a professional masseuse** can be extremely beneficial. A massage helps to get rid of muscle tension, both before and after you work out, and is good for your circulation, too.

only can it stop you aggravating existing problems, but it can also help to prevent any condition you are unwittingly heading toward. Your osteopath or physical therapist can also suggest the type of exercise that would work best for you.

## Exercise for every age

The World Health Organization defines fitness as “the ability to carry out daily tasks with alertness and efficiency while maintaining sufficient energy for leisure pursuits.” If you’re relatively fit, then this should describe you, and no matter how old you are, you can probably do most types of exercise. Yet some types of exercise may be slightly better for you at certain stages of your life.

**Your 20s** During our twenties most of us are so busy having fun that we don’t realize what an easy ride we’re having. We’ve only recently stopped growing, so our BMR is still relatively high, which means that a little exercise goes a long way.

At this age, you’re usually fit enough for any form of exercise, so choose from high-impact cardio (like running and jogging), aerobic exercise,

## >> boost the burn exercise tips

- **Do resistance training.** Lean muscle mass burns calories (see p.98) and resistance training helps build lean mass. The training works by overloading your muscles—making them perform so they’re out of their comfort zone. Use weights or kettlebells at your gym—but be sure you have an induction so you know how to use them correctly. Alternatively, work with resistance bands at home.
- **Vary your exercise.** I’ve already said that if you don’t vary your exercise, you’ll reach a “plateau.” Then you’ll find that you don’t feel as satisfied at the end of your workout as you used to. You may also be gaining weight, even if you aren’t eating more or exercising less. The reason is that your body has gotten used to a pattern of exercise, and has become more efficient as it anticipates your exercise program. So try something else!
- **Add bursts of speed to any aerobic routine.** Known as interval training, this increases your heart rate, which then burns more calories. So, if you’re walking, speed up for 20 or 30 seconds, then slow down for a minute or two. Repeat so you add two or three fast-paced intervals and gradually add longer, more intense intervals.

such as cycling or swimming, and resistance training, using your own body weight for doing exercises like squats, sit-ups, or push-ups, or using external resistance, such as a resistance band or free weights.

If you do have any specific issues you need to get to deal with, for example, serious weight problems or particularly bad posture, now is the time to do it. Your body is still young and adaptable